

Community of Practice T&L

Meeting 3

20 May 2026

The meeting focused on the theme of technology (with a lower case t). how do we engage with technology (both digital and analogue) in our teaching; and how do students respond to the various tools we teach. The session focused on the three questions below, which will be used as guiding questions for future sessions.

1. What are we doing really well?
2. What areas need improvement?
3. What are we ready to let go of?

At the end of the meeting, the group discussed the future topics of inquiry that we wish to focus on and have put together the following list (highlighted in green are the meetings that have been completed thus far):

Meeting #	Topic if Inquiry
1	Intros
2	What are we good at, what do we improve on, what do we let go of
3	<u>technology</u>
4	Student Experience
5	Indigenous Knowledge
6	(c)reativity
7	International
8	Interdisciplinarity
9	Competition
10	TBC

The summary below reflects the collective discussion on the three questions above related to technology.

What are we doing really well?

Understanding Technology as a Concept

- We are good at explaining what technology means, not just using it:
 - Technology is understood as a broad concept - not just digital tools
 - A paper and pen are technologies, language itself is a technology.Understanding materials and their environmental impact is a form of technology.

Critical Engagement with Technology and AI

- Strong emphasis on critical reflection, specifically with when and where to use technology, and identify and understand the pros and cons of different tools
- Students are encouraged to question technology, not just adopt it
- Ethics and social responsibility are embedded in how technologies are taught.

- AI is used meaningfully within teaching and learning
- **CATCHPHRASE: We value critical engagement with existing and emerging Technologies**

Adaptability and Research-Informed Teaching

- We are strong at keeping up-to-date with the latest innovations in technology and adapting our teaching to integrate these tools within our subjects.
- We are strong in integrating research into our teaching, using research as a mechanism and driver to inform our teaching practices.
- Our teaching approach is Practice-led (i.e. the academics own practice outside of the classroom) and Iterative.

Student Capability and Literacy

- Our students develop broad technological capabilities. They are not tied down to a single tool.
- Our students develop strong computational literacy but also develop strong skills in analogue technologies.
- Students recognise the continued value of non-digital tools.
- Our students leave us with the ability to critically engage with technology. We create students who can adapt, and focus less on a student who is “ready” for every tool.
 - An example of this is when students cannot afford to purchase a specific software for their subjects, they find creative ways to use free access software to fulfill the required deliverables.
- Students are supported regardless of their starting point:
 - Creating comfort and reducing the anxiety among students with no prior knowledge, and teaching from scratch when needed. Note however that some courses expect students to develop skills through self learning, which impacts the rate of knowledge acquisition within the cohort.
 - We aim to provide equitable access to technology regardless of financial background.
- We offer our students excellent access to workshop facilities and internationally leading fabrication tools (e.g. Shima Seiki Knitting Machine).-

What Areas Need Improvement?

Faculty Positioning in technology

- AI tools are evolving at rapid rates, resulting in instances where tutors are learning these tools and teaching them almost simultaneously. Faculty support is needed for ongoing development, staff upskilling and workload considerations.
- A concern that UTS is not clearly leading the space of AI/technology. The word is in our name, and so there is a perceived obligation to lead in this space.

- a. SUGGESTION: Providing a common subject(s) to all students in FDS on Digital Literacies. The challenge of making it relevant to all students will persist.. but its something worth pursuing. Tackling broad scopes/themes/challenges that are impacting all FDS disciplines. The subject can start by actually defining how we as faculty define 'technology'.

Access to Technology

- IT support, and needing access to specialised discipline specific support is deeply lacking which is impacting learning.
- Access to emerging technologies is not always available.
 - Some students can access specific software only in the labs (no floating licenses on laptops).
 - There is an ongoing cost burden to students to purchase software, especially if their ability to use labs is impacted.
 - Ai tools embedded in creative suite tools are not accessible by our students when access licensing on campus

AI Use in the Faculty

- A concern about whether there is a universal university approach to use ai? Some international students who are accustomed to using ai as a day to day in their home country, come to UTS and try to use it in the same way. They are confused when they are told that certain processes must be done without AI. We need to make sure that international students have clear guidance on AI expectations from within the faculty prior to joining.
- It is important to ensure that the use of digital technologies and AI are constantly reviewed. There is an impact of their use on the social process of learning that we find value in.

External communication

- The faculty must make sure the world knows that we engage with technology, but remain human centred (note: there is a catchphrase in their somewhere I am certain of it!)

What Are We Ready to Let Go of?

- Move away from the universal embedding of AI across all courses
 - Some disciplines are united in stepping back from or limiting its use.
- Let go of using technology as an end point.
 - Avoid adopting technology for its own sake, at the expense of human-centred initiatives.
 - Stop chasing technologies for novelty alone. Avoid adopting new tools without clear purpose or value.

- Reframe technology as a tool, not the goal.
 - It is a service, sometimes necessary, sometimes not; it is not the core driver.
- Let go of hesitation around new technologies.
 - Encourage engagement and understanding rather than avoidance.
- Move away from overly defined outcomes.
 - Allow space for experimentation. Failure is part of the learning process.